# A Message to Parents from Coach Haynes

Dear Middleburg High School Basketball Families,

You are trusting your child, who is at a crucial stage of her development, to a coach who will spend anywhere from 8 to 12 hours a week with her for the next 10 to 14 weeks. I recognize the privilege and the responsibility that come with earning your trust. With that in mind, I make these commitments to you, your daughter, and our school.

## 1. Your daughter is more than just a player.

I am a parent first and a coach second. I am not here simply to teach these girls, including my own, how to win basketball games. I am here to teach them how to be resilient, how to build self confidence, how to compete with intensity and fairness, and how to work hard, work together, and be coachable.

My goal is for every player to leave this program better prepared to succeed in life, not just on the court.

## 2. Your daughter will be coached to the best of my ability.

I hold high expectations for every girl in this program, but I will never expect more from her than I expect from myself. I will never ask her to give more to her team or this program than I am willing to give. **She will not outwork me.**

She will be corrected at times. That is part of growth. It is my goal to never embarrass her, and if I fall short of that, I will take responsibility and apologize. Correction will never be the last thing she hears from me. Encouragement always will be. Her psychological safety is a priority. She should always feel: **You are okay. You are safe. You belong.**

## 3. Our opponents will never be better prepared than I am.

Not every game will go the way we hope, and there may be moments when you question if I know what I am doing. That is understandable. Please know that I work very hard to never be outworked by another coach. I take my responsibility to prepare and to put our kids in the best position to succeed very seriously.

## 4. You are never unwelcome in our program.*

You are not permitted on the bench or court during games or practices, unless you are responding to an injury. You are always welcome to attend practices and to ask questions about how and why we do things the way we do. I am committed to building a program that invites healthy and respectful parent involvement.

*Parents who violate the team's parent expectations may be an exception to this.

# Parent Expectations

To give everyone a successful and unified season, please review and agree to the expectations below.

## Parent Volunteer Roles

Our players deserve a dedicated community around them, so full parent participation is essential. Every family is expected to step up and contribute, whether that means donating resources, giving your time, or taking on a leadership role. Something must be sacrificed for this team to have the season it deserves. Roles we need filled:

- Team Parent Coordinator
- Game Day Clock Operator
- Game Day Shot Clock Operator
- Media Assistant
- Fundraising Lead
- Concession Lead (must be Level 2 cleared)
- Banquet Planning

Claim your role here: Roles Signup Sheet

## Sideline Expectations

- Support all players and coaches positively from the stands.
- Do not coach from the sideline. Let the coaches coach.
- Encourage your player with love, patience, and support, win or lose.

## Crowd Energy and Cheer Culture

- Clap and cheer every time a substitution is made. It is a small but powerful way to support the whole team.
- Silence kills momentum. Bring positive cheering, clapping, and organized chants. Our team feeds off your energy.
- **New this year:** at the end of the season we will award a Biggest Hype Man prize to the parent who brings the most consistent and creative positive energy to the crowd, especially those who lead chants and keep the sideline lively.

## Sportsmanship

- Show respect toward referees, players, coaches, and fans at all times.
- Confrontations or negativity will be addressed and may affect your attendance at games.

## Communication

- Questions or concerns? Have your athlete schedule a time to speak with the head coach first. Game time is not the place for feedback or complaints.
- **24 hour rule:** no parent approaches a coach with a concern until 24 hours after a game has passed.
- We use **Apptegy and SportsYou** for all official team updates. Make sure you are connected. Schedules and any changes are shared there and on our shared schedule spreadsheet.

## Saturday Bronco Brainstorm Sessions: Parent Experts and Sponsors Wanted

On Saturdays we run Bronco Brainstorm, Life Skills 101: Real World Readiness, eleven modules on money, taxes, legal documents, home and vehicle care, cooking, communication, careers, health and first aid, critical thinking, and entrepreneurship. If you are an expert in any of these areas and can lead or guest speak, or you own a business that could sponsor a session, please contact me directly.

# Parent Acknowledgment

By signing below, I confirm that I have read Coach Haynes' message and the Parent Expectations for the 2026 to 2027 season, that I understand them, and that I agree to follow them. I also understand that parents who violate these expectations may lose some of the access described in the commitments above.

## PARENT OR GUARDIAN

Parent or guardian name (print) _____ Phone _____

Parent or guardian signature _____ Date _____

Email _____

My daughter's name (print) _____ ☐ Varsity ☐ JV

## HOW I WILL HELP THIS SEASON

Volunteer role I will claim on the Roles Signup Sheet _____

Thank you for your commitment, sacrifice, and continuous support. Let us make this an unforgettable season for our young women. Warm regards, Coach Haynes, Head Coach, Middleburg High School Girls Basketball.